English • Enterprise, equality and community impact

Women Empowerment

Through Entrepreneurship • Official activities • Idioms • Punctuation • Formal application

Unit 5 • Complete official activities • Entrepreneurship, Community and Formal Writing

Text at a glance

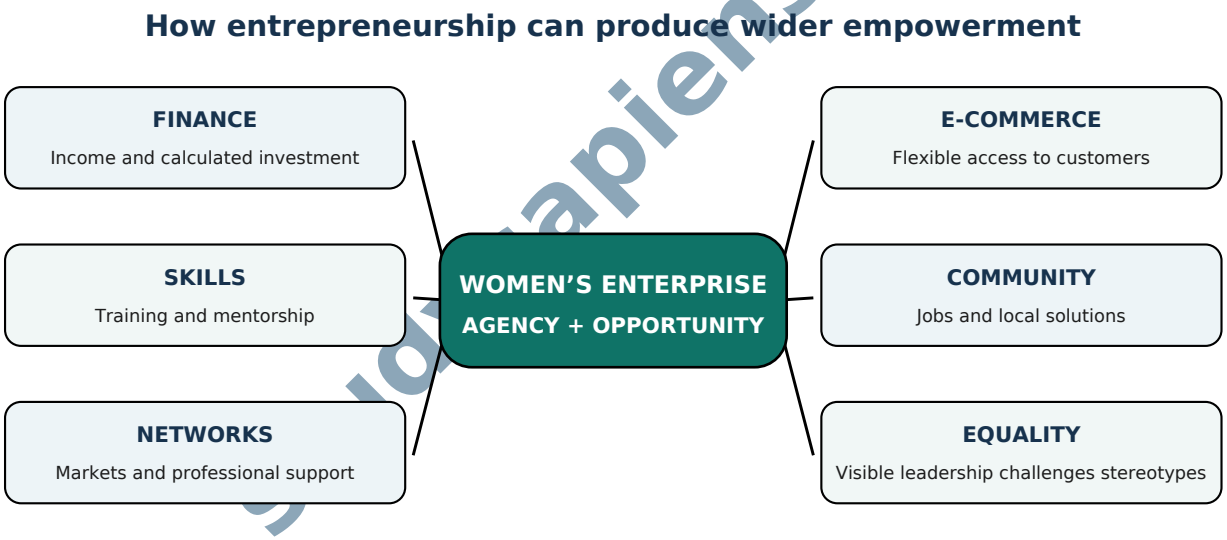
• **Entrepreneurship:** Starting, managing and growing a venture by identifying opportunities, taking calculated risks and turning innovative ideas into products or services.

• **Central argument:** Women's entrepreneurship creates financial independence and leadership while benefiting communities through employment, innovation and social development.

• **Historical example:** Hazrat Khadija (RA), whose wisdom, integrity, strategic thinking and leadership made her a successful businesswoman.

• **Language focus:** Viewpoint, connotation, proverbs, idioms, punctuation, discussion, biography/autobiography and a formal sponsorship application.

Figure 1 — Original enterprise-to-community impact map



Main idea in the centre → supporting details → examples → a clear concluding sentence

Reading viewpoint: The main passage uses third-person narration. This gives a broad overview of several entrepreneurs and social trends rather than limiting the account to one participant's personal experience.

Pre-Reading and While-Reading

P1. What is entrepreneurship, and why is it important today?

Entrepreneurship is the process of creating and developing a business around a product, service or solution. It matters because entrepreneurs respond to unmet needs, introduce innovation, generate income and create employment. Responsible enterprises can also solve social problems, although profit should be balanced with fair work, honesty and environmental care.

P2. Name women entrepreneurs and discuss challenges they may face.

The passage names Hazrat Khadija (RA) as an early example and discusses modern Pakistani women in trade, technology, food, fashion, education and crafts. Challenges can include restricted access to loans and training, cultural expectations, mobility constraints, legal procedures and a shortage of mentors or professional networks. Any additional contemporary example should be supported by reliable research.

P3. What role can women entrepreneurs play in improving communities?

They can employ local people, especially women and youth; provide affordable education, healthcare or childcare; develop products suited to local needs; and serve as visible role models. Their income and leadership can increase household security while their enterprises circulate money, skills and confidence within the community.

Margin question. What role are women entrepreneurs playing in modern-day Pakistan?

They are building visible businesses in urban centres, smaller towns and rural areas across fashion, technology, food, education and crafts. Through determination and innovation, they contribute to economic activity, create opportunities and challenge assumptions about women's leadership.

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Reading and Critical Thinking

A. Answer the following questions.

1. Which qualities made Hazrat Khadija (RA) successful in a male-dominated society, and how can modern women apply them?

Her wisdom supported sound decisions; integrity built trust; leadership organized a thriving enterprise; and strategic thinking helped her expand trade across regions. Hard work and intelligence allowed her to succeed without treating gender as a limit. Modern entrepreneurs can apply the same qualities through careful market research, honest dealing, financial planning, skilled team management and long-term decisions rather than impulsive risk-taking.

2. How do women-led businesses contribute to economic development and job creation, especially in rural areas?

They produce goods and services, generate income, purchase inputs and improve productivity, all of which strengthen economic activity. Their enterprises can employ women and young people who may otherwise have limited local options. In rural areas, handicrafts, food processing, training centres and online sales can connect local skills with wider markets, reducing unemployment and keeping more income within the community.

3. Why are mentorship and networking critical, and how do women's chambers of commerce enhance growth?

Mentors share practical knowledge, warn against avoidable mistakes and help new entrepreneurs set realistic goals. Networks provide contacts with suppliers, customers, trainers and financiers. Women's chambers of commerce bring these resources together, offer platforms to display products and create a collective professional voice. Such support reduces isolation and improves access to opportunities that an individual might struggle to find alone.

4. How does e-commerce help overcome mobility and societal barriers?

Online platforms allow entrepreneurs to display products, communicate with customers and receive orders without travelling to a physical shop for every transaction. Home-based digital work can offer flexible hours and access to customers beyond the immediate neighbourhood. It is not a complete solution—internet access, digital literacy, safe delivery and fair online payments are also needed—but it can reduce several practical constraints.

5. How does women entrepreneurs' success act as a catalyst for future generations?

Visible success turns an abstract possibility into a believable path. Girls and other women can observe leadership, decision-making and financial independence in real people, then imagine similar ambitions for themselves. Role models may also provide advice, training or employment. The resulting confidence and opportunities extend influence beyond one business and gradually weaken restrictive stereotypes.

6. What is the community impact, and how can it address education and healthcare?

Community-focused enterprises direct business skills towards unmet local needs. An entrepreneur may establish a low-cost learning centre, vocational course, daycare facility or health-awareness service; employ local staff; and reinvest part of the income in outreach. To leverage this impact, communities and institutions can identify priority needs, provide training or microfinance, build partnerships with qualified professionals and measure whether services genuinely reach underserved people.

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7. How do limited loans affect women, and what can create fairer financial opportunities?

Without affordable credit, a woman may be unable to buy equipment, hold inventory, hire workers or survive early losses. High collateral demands and limited financial records can make exclusion worse. Solutions include responsibly assessed microfinance, financial-literacy training, transparent lending criteria, suitable collateral alternatives, savings facilities and mentorship. Support should avoid exploitative interest or pushing borrowers into debt they cannot manage.

8. How does participation in entrepreneurship challenge stereotypes and promote equality?

Each successful woman leader demonstrates that business judgment, innovation and decision-making are not male-only abilities. Employment and income also increase women's agency in households and communities. When institutions respond with fairer finance, training and legal access, individual examples can contribute to structural change. Equality grows as women are evaluated by competence and contribution rather than by assumptions about traditional roles.

B. Choose the correct option.

1. How does entrepreneurship help women challenge societal norms?

(b) by providing financial independence and leadership roles in their communities.

2. How do societal norms influence success?

(b) They often impose limitations that restrict women's ability to balance household duties with business aspirations.

3. What can be inferred about job creation?

(a) Women entrepreneurs contribute to job creation, especially for other women and youth in their communities.

4. How can women's entrepreneurship promote gender equality?

(b) by challenging stereotypes and promoting women as capable leaders and decision-makers.

5. What is the long-term benefit of acting as role models?

(c) It empowers women to pursue their ambitions.

C. Complete the statements with appropriate words or phrases.

1. Entrepreneurship is the process of starting, managing and growing a **business** venture.

2. Entrepreneurs identify **opportunities**, take calculated risks and bring innovative ideas to life.

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3. Hazrat Khadija (RA) was a successful **businesswoman / entrepreneur** from Makkah Mukarramah known for wisdom and leadership.

4. A major benefit is that it promotes **gender equality** by challenging traditional gender roles.

5. In Pakistan, women entrepreneurs are active in fashion, technology, **food** and education; crafts are another sector named in the passage.

Concise unit summary

• Entrepreneurship enables women to develop ideas, manage ventures and gain financial independence. Hazrat Khadija (RA) illustrates the enduring value of integrity, wisdom and strategic leadership. In Pakistan, women work in fashion, food, crafts, education and technology despite financial, cultural, mobility, legal and networking barriers. Microfinance, mentorship, chambers of commerce, e-commerce and institutional support can widen opportunity. Women-led enterprises create jobs, address local needs, encourage innovation and inspire future generations, thereby strengthening both communities and gender equality.

Vocabulary: Connotation, Proverbs and Idioms

A. Distinguish denotative and connotative meanings.

Word	Denotation	Connotation in this unit
entrepreneur	a person who starts and runs a business venture	initiative, innovation, responsible risk and leadership
empowerment	the process of gaining power, authority or control	dignity, agency, equality and freedom to shape one’s future
independence	the state of not depending on another for support or control	self-reliance, confidence and freedom of choice
barrier	something that physically blocks movement or access	social, financial, legal or mobility obstacles to opportunity
success	achievement of an aim or desired outcome	overcoming constraints while creating community benefit, not merely wealth

B. Complete with the given proverbs.

Sentence	Proverb and meaning
1. If you want to succeed, remember that …	(a) **actions speak louder than words** — achievements and behaviour prove more than promises.
2. Let's start our work now because …	(b) **a stitch in time saves nine** — prompt action prevents a larger problem.
3. To be successful, start your day early because …	(c) **the early bird catches the worm** — early action can secure an opportunity.
4. To minimize risks when making important decisions, …	(d) **don't put all your eggs in one basket** — avoid depending on one option for everything.
5. When meeting someone new, remember that …	(e) **you can't judge a book by its cover** — appearance alone does not reveal character or value.

C. Match idioms with meanings.

Idiom	Key	Meaning
i. break the ice	e	make people feel more comfortable
ii. once in a blue moon	a	very rarely
iii. a piece of cake	d	something very easy
iv. hit the nail on the head	b	say or do something exactly right
v. cost an arm and a leg	c	be very expensive

D. Identify idioms/proverbs and explain literal and figurative meanings.

Expression	Literal picture	Figurative meaning in context
making strides; odds stacked against them	taking long steps; chances piled unevenly	making progress although circumstances make success difficult
slow and steady wins the race	a steady competitor can win a literal race	consistent, careful effort is more effective than hurried, uneven effort

Expression	Literal picture	Figurative meaning in context
breaking new ground; paving the way	digging untouched land; constructing a road	introducing new activity; making later progress easier for others
rise above it; actions speak louder than words	move physically higher; actions produce more volume	refuse to be controlled by criticism; deeds demonstrate ability better than claims
where there's a will, there's a way	determination and a route are pictured as connected	strong determination helps people find solutions despite limited resources

Grammar: Punctuation and Capitalisation

A. Insert punctuation and capitals in the Fatima Jinnah passage.

Corrected passage

• Fatima Jinnah was a remarkable woman. She was the younger sister of Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah. Although she initially studied dentistry, she later became a prominent figure in the struggle for independence. Fatima Jinnah was not only known for her contributions to the cause but also for her efforts in advocating for women's rights. What an inspiring legacy she left behind! Despite her achievements, she faced many challenges and opposition. How did she manage to remain so dedicated and firm? Her influence on Pakistan's history is undeniable and continues to be remembered today.

B. Write a paragraph on "The Role of Women Empowerment in Society".

Model paragraph

• Women's empowerment strengthens society by enabling women to exercise their rights, develop their abilities and participate in decision-making. When girls receive education and women gain fair access to employment, finance and leadership, households become more secure and communities benefit from a wider range of talent. Empowerment also encourages self-reliance, but it does not mean working in isolation: supportive families, inclusive institutions and responsible public policies are equally important. How can a society achieve its full potential if half of its population faces avoidable barriers? By removing discrimination and expanding opportunity, we can build a more just, productive and forward-looking society.

Language check: Sentences and proper nouns begin with capitals; the possessive is *women's*; the direct question ends with a question mark; *decision-making*, *self-reliance* and *forward-looking* use appropriate hyphenation.

Oral Communication Skills

A. Group discussion: select a section, identify its main idea and present supporting details.

Model group presentation — E-commerce and support networks

• **Main idea:** Digital platforms and strong support networks help women continue businesses despite mobility and social constraints.

• **Supporting details:** Entrepreneurs can sell through online platforms from home, reach wider markets and share advice or opportunities with other businesswomen. Government bodies and NGOs add finance, training and market access.

• **Class-discussion conclusion:** These supports are most effective when combined with internet access, digital skills, safe payments and protection from online exploitation. Success therefore depends on both individual resilience and an inclusive environment.

B(i). Tell a short entrepreneurial story and reflect on its inspiration.

Hazrat Khadija (RA): a short narrative

• Hazrat Khadija (RA) managed a thriving trading business in a society where commercial leadership was dominated by men. She did not rely on wealth alone. Through wisdom, integrity and strategic planning, she expanded her ventures across regions and earned trust. Each careful decision strengthened both her enterprise and her reputation. Her influence reached beyond trade because her example demonstrated that gender need not prevent a woman from becoming a capable leader. Her story inspires future entrepreneurs to combine ambition with ethical conduct, preparation and perseverance.

B(ii). Role-play a community meeting.

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Completed role-play dialogue

• **Entrepreneur:** “Thank you for coming. My training and handicraft business creates opportunities for women and challenges the assumption that they cannot lead enterprises.”
• **Community member:** “Your centre has given several women reliable work. Their income supports their families, and their new skills have encouraged younger girls to learn.”
• **Local government official:** “We recognize this contribution. We can offer a skills-development session, responsible microfinance guidance and a stall at the district business fair.”
• **Aspiring entrepreneur:** “I admire your work. What advice would you give someone starting a similar venture?”
• **Entrepreneur:** “Begin with a small community survey, calculate costs honestly and test one product before expanding. Find a mentor, keep clear records and never compromise quality or fair dealing.”
• **Community member:** “We can support by recommending local trainees and buying responsibly made products, while you provide transparent wages and training.”

C–D. Discuss handling challenges; listen and respond thoughtfully.

Model discussion contribution

• Modern women entrepreneurs may face criticism, limited credit, mobility restrictions and weak professional networks. Resilience means responding strategically rather than denying these difficulties. A businesswoman can join a chamber of commerce, seek a mentor, document her finances, use e-commerce and request appropriate institutional support. Community-focused entrepreneurship can also address education, healthcare and employment, creating benefits beyond personal profit. When listening to another group, we should ask for evidence, acknowledge a strong point and offer alternatives respectfully.

Video Activity and Personal Response

E. Fill in the missing information from the linked video activity.

Name	Achievement
Hazrat Khadija (RA)	The first Muslim female entrepreneur — the activity’s wording
Fatima al-Fihri	Founded the institution at al-Qarawiyyin in Fez, described in the activity as the world’s first university
Maryam al-Astrolabi	**Designed and crafted sophisticated astrolabes**, contributing to astronomy, navigation and timekeeping

Name	Achievement
Sutayta al-Mahamali	**Excelled in mathematics**, especially arithmetic and inheritance/successoral calculations
Dhayfa Khatun	Founded two Islamic schools in Aleppo, including al-Firdaws
Rufaida al-Aslamia	Recognized in the activity as the first female nurse and trainer

Accuracy note: The table completes the intended educational activity. “First” claims can depend on definitions and historical evidence; Maryam is more precisely described as an astrolabe maker/developer, not the inventor of the instrument itself.

F. Discuss your favourite female entrepreneur and explain why.

Model personal response

• My favourite example in this unit is Hazrat Khadija (RA) because her entrepreneurship combined commercial success with wisdom, integrity and leadership. She expanded trade through strategic decisions rather than treating inherited wealth as a substitute for ability. Her example remains relevant because modern enterprises still depend on trust, careful planning and ethical conduct. I also admire how her success challenges the assumption that leadership belongs to only one gender.

Writing Skills: Draft, Edit, Proofread and Apply

A. Part 1: Write a biographical or autobiographical paragraph on community impact.

Original third-person biography — Sana Ahmed

• Sana Ahmed, a resident of a small Pakistani town, transformed her embroidery skill into a training and craft enterprise that benefited her community. At first, limited savings and restricted access to a physical market made expansion difficult. She attended a local mentorship programme, priced her products carefully and began displaying them through an online platform. As orders increased, she employed six women and trained several young people in stitching, record-keeping and customer service. Her venture created income, preserved a traditional craft and gave other women the confidence to develop their own skills. Sana’s story shows how resilience, digital access and responsible leadership can turn one person’s ability into shared opportunity.

B–C. Parts 2–3: Edit for content and proofread for correctness.

Check	Application to the model
Clear main idea and examples	The topic sentence identifies Sana's community impact; finance, mentorship, online sales, employment and training support it.
Challenge and contribution	Limited savings and market access lead to specific solutions and measurable community benefits.
Logical flow	Skill → obstacles → support and strategy → business growth → wider impact → lesson.
Complete sentences and agreement	Each sentence has a subject and finite verb; "six women" and "several young people" take plural forms.
Spelling, capitals and punctuation	Sana Ahmed and Pakistani are capitalized; list commas and final full stops are checked.
Formatting	One coherent paragraph is used for the biography; a formal application below follows letter conventions.

D. Application requesting sponsorship for a women entrepreneurs' workshop.

Model formal application

The Programme Coordinator
Community Learning Society
Karachi
7 November 2026

The Head
ABC Business Organisation
Karachi

Subject: Request for Sponsorship of a Women Entrepreneurs' Workshop

Respected Sir/Madam,

I am writing to request your organisation's sponsorship for a one-day Women Entrepreneurs' Workshop being organised by the Community Learning Society for 40 aspiring businesswomen from low-income neighbourhoods. The workshop will provide practical training in business planning, budgeting, digital marketing, product presentation and responsible access to microfinance.

Many participants have promising skills but lack professional guidance, market contacts and confidence in formal business procedures. Experienced mentors will

help them prepare simple business plans, while a networking session will connect them with local suppliers and entrepreneurs. Your support of PKR 150,000 would cover training materials, venue arrangements, refreshments and participant travel support. We would acknowledge your organisation in the programme and submit a brief outcomes report after the event.

This workshop will help participants develop sustainable enterprises, create future employment and contribute more effectively to their communities. I would be grateful for an opportunity to discuss the proposed budget and sponsorship arrangements. Thank you for considering this request.

Yours faithfully,
Areeba Khan
Programme Coordinator
Community Learning Society
contact@example.org

Original Exam-Practice MCQs

1. An entrepreneur primarily:

(a) avoids every risk
(b) identifies opportunities and develops a venture
(c) works only in a corporation
(d) depends on inherited wealth

Answer: (b) identifies opportunities and develops a venture — Entrepreneurship combines opportunity, innovation and calculated risk.

2. Microfinance is intended to provide:

(a) financial services to underserved people
(b) free university degrees
(c) astronomical instruments
(d) legal court decisions

Answer: (a) financial services to underserved people — It can include small loans and savings facilities.

3. Which is a mobility barrier?

(a) a business plan
(b) restricted travel to clients and markets
(c) a mentorship session
(d) a product display

Answer: (b) restricted travel to clients and markets — Movement restrictions can reduce market access.

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4. E-commerce most directly helps by:

(a) abolishing all costs
(b) widening access to customers through digital platforms
(c) removing the need for skills
(d) guaranteeing profit

Answer: (b) widening access to customers through digital platforms — Online trade can reduce location and mobility constraints.

5. “Once in a blue moon” means:

(a) very rarely
(b) very easy
(c) very expensive
(d) exactly right

Answer: (a) very rarely — It describes infrequent occurrence.

6. “Don’t put all your eggs in one basket” advises:

(a) early rising
(b) prompt repair
(c) risk diversification
(d) judging appearance

Answer: (c) risk diversification — Avoid relying on only one option.

7. Which apostrophe is correct?

(a) womens rights
(b) women’s rights
(c) womens’ rights
(d) womans rights

Answer: (b) women’s rights — Women is already plural; add apostrophe + s.

8. Third-person narration uses:

(a) only I and we
(b) he, she, they or names
(c) no characters
(d) only direct questions

Answer: (b) he, she, they or names — The narrator stands outside the events.

9. Editing chiefly improves:

(a) content, clarity and structure
(b) font size only
(c) rhyme only
(d) the paper colour

Answer: (a) content, clarity and structure — Proofreading later checks surface correctness.

10. A formal sponsorship application should include:

(a) an unclear purpose
(b) purpose, benefits and a specific request
(c) only a proverb
(d) an informal greeting and no subject

Answer: (b) purpose, benefits and a specific request — The reader needs a clear case and actionable request.

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Points to Remember

Enterprise: opportunity + innovation + calculated risk + management.

Barriers: cultural expectations, limited finance/resources, mobility, legal procedures and weak networks.

Support: mentorship, chambers of commerce, microfinance, training, e-commerce and institutional access.

Community effects: jobs, income, innovation, local services, role models and gender equality.

Connotation adds associations to literal meaning; **idioms** have non-literal meanings; **proverbs** express general advice or truth.

Third-person biography uses names and she/they; **first-person autobiography** uses I/we.

Formal application: addresses, date, subject, salutation, clear request, benefits, closure and signature.

MCQ key at a glance

Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key
1	b	2	a	3	b	4	b	5	a
6	c	7	b	8	b	9	a	10	b

How to attempt this unit in the paper

- For impact questions, connect business activity to employment, income, services and changed attitudes.
- Do not claim that e-commerce removes every barrier; mention digital skills, connectivity and safe transactions.
- For idioms, explain the intended meaning rather than translating every word literally.
- After editing content, proofread separately for capitals, apostrophes, commas and sentence boundaries.
- In an application, make the sponsorship amount or requested support realistic and state exactly how it will benefit participants.